

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 257

By Johnson

A RESOLUTION to recognize the 125th anniversary of John Bouchard & Sons Co.

WHEREAS, John Bouchard & Sons Co. was founded in 1900 near Nashville's Capitol Hill by John Bouchard and his two sons as a machine shop; and

WHEREAS, today, John Bouchard & Sons Co. is a fifth-generation, family owned and operated business in Nashville that is dedicated to building and sustaining durable infrastructure throughout the Mid-South; and

WHEREAS, John Bouchard, originally from Quebec, Canada, immigrated during the Civil War era to Chicago, Illinois, where he rose to serve as chief engineer for P.D. Armour's meatpacking plant, which, by innovation, processed more than one million animals per year and became one of the largest in the country, with a facility covering five city blocks; and

WHEREAS, he received three U.S. patents for his inventions, including a hog-scraping machine, a switch for overhead tracks, and an ammonia refrigerating machine, of which kind many were installed for the Armour plant and their competitors; and

WHEREAS, he brought this innovative mindset to Tennessee, where his company designed, installed, and maintained the first refrigeration systems for institutions such as the Hermitage Hotel, Vanderbilt University Hospital, Tennessee State Penitentiary, Standard Candy, Capitol Theater, Lookout Mountain Hotel, and ice-manufacturing facilities from Jackson to Knoxville; and

WHEREAS, the company has grown into a diversified business of nearly 200 employees and now provides not only machine shop services but also iron construction castings, sales and servicing of air compressors and other industrial equipment, and construction services in the mechanical, plumbing, electrical, and fire-sprinkler trades to thousands of commercial,

institutional, industrial, and municipal customers throughout the Mid-South region, including the Tennessee Department of Transportation; Oak Ridge National Laboratory; Eastman Chemical; State universities, including the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, University of Tennessee at Chattanooga, Middle Tennessee State University, Tennessee Technological University, Austin Peay State University, and Tennessee State University; Nashville's multiple water and wastewater treatment plants; Tennessee Valley Authority; Vanderbilt University and Medical Center; Bridgestone Americas; Coca-Cola Bottling; Schermerhorn Symphony Center; Tennessee State Museum; more than 100 Starbucks stores; Memphis and Nashville international airports; and thousands of others in between; and

WHEREAS, just like their castings featuring the JBS diamond that are located on streets throughout the region, John Bouchard & Sons Co. is an integral, yet often unnoticed, component of the Mid-South's infrastructure; and

WHEREAS, today, the company is still headquartered in its original location on Harrison Street, with its foundry operation a few blocks away, operates branch offices in Knoxville, Elizabethtown, Kentucky, and Evansville, Indiana, and is led by Lisa Bouchard Morgan, the great-great-granddaughter of its founder, and her husband, William Morgan; and

WHEREAS, the company has been certified as a Woman Business Enterprise by the Governor's Office of Diversity Business Enterprise for the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee Department of Economic and Community Development recently recognized John Bouchard & Sons Co. as one of its Centennial Tennessee Companies, which together "represent the State's thriving industries and have provided countless opportunities to Tennesseans in communities across the State"; and

WHEREAS, Bouchard's leaders and employees have always given back to their communities, from raising funds for World War I through the sale of U.S. Liberty Bonds, to

numerous employees who served during World War II, the Korean Conflict, Vietnam, and the Global War on Terror; and

WHEREAS, the company's legacy of public service ranges from John E. Bouchard, Sr.'s volunteer leadership as president of the Nashville Boys' Club from 1928 through 1941, to John E. Bouchard III's leadership in the late 1970s as the Nashville Rotary Club's president in establishing the Tennessee Girl's Ranch, to the company's 2010 participation in *Extreme Home Makeover*'s rebuilding of Lighthouse Christian School after the Nashville flood, and finally to its support of multiple charities throughout the State today; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize John Bouchard & Sons Co. on the occasion of the company's 125th anniversary, extending our congratulations to this fifth-generation, family owned and operated Nashville-based business for its significant contributions to building and sustaining durable infrastructure throughout Tennessee and the Mid-South region.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.